Melissa Heffler

PEOPLE OPERATIONS
EMPLOYEE EXPERIENCE
EVENTS & ENGAGEMENT

CONTACT

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SUMMARY

People operations professional with 10+ years across global retail, professional sports, and media at Gap Inc., the NFL, MLB, and AOL. Shapes how people join and connect in an organization, from first interview and preboarding to offsites and enterprise-scale events. Independently spots better ways to get work done, translates needs into practical solutions, and manages high-touch processes with accuracy and care, backing every change with data leadership can act on.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Candidate experience, preboarding, event planning, employee advocacy, process improvement, reporting & insights, project management, stakeholder partnership, vendor & contract management, cross-functional collaboration

TOOLS

Workday, Greenhouse, Power Automate, SharePoint, Power Apps, Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, SAP Concur, Canva, Adobe Creative Suite

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University
2011 – 2015

EXPERIENCE

Gap Inc.

Oct 2021 – Present

Senior Talent Acquisition Specialist, Global Technology Solutions & Corporate Functions

NEW-HIRE & CANDIDATE JOURNEY

- Steward the handoff from Talent Acquisition to the Happy You're Here onboarding team, rewriting preboarding and contractor-conversion messaging that cuts new-hire follow-ups and sets clear first-day expectations.
- Direct the candidate journey for Global Technology Solutions and Corporate Functions, managing 1,500+ interviews annually, including executive and VP+ processes spanning multiple locations and time zones.
- Standardize interviewer enablement materials and branded candidate messaging, giving every hiring team the same polished, consistent experience.

EVENTS & TEAM CONNECTION

- Produce offsites and team events for large groups of attendees, handling venue sourcing, vendor coordination, hotel accommodations, agendas, and on-site execution within budget.
- Direct Gap Inc.'s presence at a national technology industry conference, overseeing booth, technology, vendors, and invoicing; author a playbook for repeat participation.
- Facilitate biweekly specialist forums to surface blockers and workshop solutions, converting team input into process improvements.

AUTOMATION, DATA & EFFICIENCY

- Independently design and run a four-part scheduling automation program (intake, event build, candidate communications, volume and reschedule tracking), cutting scheduling turnaround by 75% while preserving human review.
- Deliver intake builders, automated messaging, and live dashboards that let hiring managers and recruiters answer routine questions on their own, freeing team capacity for higher-value work.
- Proactively build leadership dashboards tracking interview volume, reschedule rates by team and level, and workload distribution; use the findings to make the business case for a dedicated candidate experience function.
- Solely create and own customized org-planning decks for senior leadership, giving each leader an at-a-glance view of open and recently filled roles, pipeline progress, requisition status, and interview panels.
- Automate weekly open-requisition reporting, eliminating manual Excel preparation and recovering an hour per week.

National Football League

Sep 2018 – Sep 2021

Senior Coordinator, Administration & Facilities

- Owned travel planning and on-the-ground coordination for 1,000+ corporate employees at the Super Bowl, Pro Bowl, Draft, and Kickoff, along with event staffing.
- Built event playbooks and a standardized company-wide travel process, supported by new tools and communications, across four marquee events each year.
- Oversaw key vendor partnerships, working with Legal and Finance on contract negotiations and service delivery.
- Served as the employee voice to leadership on engagement, workplace concerns, and space planning, and owned follow-through on responses.

Major League Baseball

Jun 2016 – Aug 2018

Recruiting & Employee Services Coordinator

- Supported employees from recruiting through day-to-day experience, partnering with leadership on workspace needs, event requirements, and staffing schedules.
- Created and hosted candidate meet-and-greets introducing finalists to the company's culture before offer acceptance.

AOL

Oct 2015 – Feb 2016

Executive Projects Assistant

- Planned corporate events and executive gifting programs; managed the CEO's calendar, travel, and conference logistics.